

WOODWINDS / PRODUCT DOSSIER

E-flat alto saxophone

AS-300 Copperlane

Reedbank Works / line W5



Figure 1. AI-generated illustration of the fictional flagship; not a specification photograph.

Synthetic training corpus. The company, factories, models, performers, events, measurements and commercial records are fictional. Generated images are illustrative, not engineering drawings.

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01 / HISTORY

A workshop history, not a generic instrument

The e-flat alto saxophone occupies a distinct place in the Aster Vale Instruments catalogue. The company was founded in 1958 as a fictional repair workshop and gradually became a manufacturer. Its first model in this instrument family appeared in 1985, rather than at the company's founding. Today production belongs to Reedbank Works, line W5. That assignment identifies the responsible workshop, not a retailer or a place where a famous performance happened. All names and records in this dossier belong to the synthetic Aster Vale setting.

The broader instrument tradition provides context rather than a claim of invention. Our design draws on nineteenth-century saxophone invention followed by band, jazz and contemporary concert use. In the current instrument, a single reed excites a conical brass bore bent into a compact shape; the reed makes it a woodwind despite the metal body. Aster Vale did not invent that operating principle. Its contribution in this catalogue is a particular production and service approach: the replaceable neck-receiver collar that preserves the body when a touring neck fit wears loose. A buyer comparing brands should distinguish an established acoustic principle from a model-specific construction detail.

The 1985 AS-65 focused on durable school keywork. A 2000 touring study highlighted receiver wear as a major repair cost. The 2009 AS-175 introduced a replaceable neck-receiver collar. Copperlane launched in 2017 with revised low-key geometry. A 2024 spring revision reduced left-hand table effort without changing the reference mouthpiece. These events explain why the current flagship looks and behaves as it does. They are internal milestones in the fictional company's history, not dates for the invention of the instrument itself. Earlier instruments remain eligible for assessment, but a modern replacement part is not assumed to fit an older production series merely because the family name is the same.

The current range consists of AS-100 Foundation, AS-200 Atelier and AS-300 Copperlane. Foundation is the access model, Atelier adds individual fitting time, and the 300-series flagship receives the longest voicing and final assessment. None is a miniature or a different instrument family. The shared nominal overall height (mm) is 690 across these three standard configurations. A dealer must not infer a shorter scale or smaller cabinet from the lower price.

The design compromise is deliberate: large resonators can brighten attacks but do not compensate for poor pad seating or an unsuitable mouthpiece. The company therefore avoids describing one material or one number as a universal quality score. An instrument can pass its dimensional specification and still require a setup suited to the player. Conversely, a player may prefer a lower-priced configuration because its response fits a particular room, technique or transport routine. The model ladder is a selection aid, not a ranking of musicians.

The history also explains our service policy. The documented repair emphasis is receiver-collar replacement and low-key regulation, supported by a serial-based parts record. Changes made in a later revision are not quietly attributed to an earlier model. A repairer records whether the instrument remains in its original configuration or has received an approved update. That distinction matters when a performer, dealer and workshop discuss the same instrument using different informal names.

02 / PERFORMERS

The player problem shapes the flagship

In the fictional Aster Vale music scene, Miles Sedge is the best-known advocate of AS-300 Copperlane. The performer works with The Copperlane Five and used the model for the fictional 2021 Side Street Stories album. This is an invented endorsement within the training setting, not a claim about a real artist. The useful part of the story is the playing requirement: a broad middle register with precise low-note attacks at quiet dynamics. That requirement gives a concrete reason to discuss response rather than relying on a decorative celebrity name.

The session brief asked the workshop to preserve that musical outcome at both rehearsal and performance levels. The technician began with the standard instrument, documented the player's setup and changed only one variable at a time. The team did not turn an artist's preference into a new factory limit. The release specification remained the same; the performer record described the adjustments and accessories used for this particular engagement.

A second fictional performer, Cora Lake, uses this family for classical saxophone quartet work. The two stories are intentionally different. A setting that supports the first brief may not be ideal for the second. A dealer should therefore ask about venue, ensemble, typical dynamics and maintenance access before recommending the flagship. The correct question is which response the player needs, not which performer has the most recognizable name.

Our comparison passage starts gently, reaches the player's normal performance level and returns to a quiet ending. The listener pays attention to onset, continuity and decay, not simply maximum loudness. The player repeats the passage on Foundation, Atelier and AS-300 Copperlane, with rest between attempts. The sequence can be reversed to reduce

the influence of fatigue or expectation. A higher list price is not revealed as a cue before the listening comparison.

The flagship's characteristic serviceable feature is the replaceable neck-receiver collar that preserves the body when a touring neck fit wears loose. In the artist programme, the workshop explains what this feature does and what it does not do. It supports repeatable construction or service, but it does not replace musical technique. It also does not guarantee a particular recorded tone in an unknown room. The performer remains responsible for the artistic choice; the workshop remains responsible for the documented instrument condition.

An artist loan is checked before dispatch and again on return. The record includes the serial, model revision, accessories, visible condition and the agreed setup. Changes made on tour are recorded rather than silently reset. The celebrated performance establishes a narrative about use, while the return inspection establishes the physical condition of that instrument. Neither replaces the production acceptance checks described in the quality section of this dossier.

03 / MANUFACTURING

Reedbank Works owns the complete build route

Production of the e-flat alto saxophone is assigned to Reedbank Works, line W5. The current material specification uses a brass body and neck, lacquered key cups, leather pads with resonators and a hard-rubber mouthpiece. Incoming material is identified before it reaches the bench. A supplier description alone is not an acceptance record: the workshop checks the features relevant to this family and records the batch that entered the instrument. Finish and cosmetic matching happen later, after the parts have passed their structural checks.

The route has six named stages, and their order is part of the manufacturing record. At form brass body, the technician must inspect seams before lacquer. At draw tone holes, the technician must check each rim for flatness. At fit neck collar, the technician must gauge receiver fit with the matched neck. At mount key stacks, the technician must balance spring force on the left-hand table. At seat leather pads, the technician must recheck the low pads after mechanism settling. At test low attacks, the technician must use the recorded mouthpiece and reed combination. A later stage cannot erase a missing earlier inspection. When a technician finds a problem, the traveller records which operation needs correction and which downstream checks must be repeated. That makes the route useful for a repair conversation as well as for production planning.

At seat leather pads, the workshop establishes the player's working setup rather than simply making the instrument look finished. The technician must recheck the low pads after mechanism settling. That operation is performed with the specified parts and accessories, not whatever happens to be available at the bench. A substitution is documented and evaluated as a substitution. It is not folded into the standard model record as though nothing changed.

The final route operation is test low attacks. Its purpose is to expose a functional problem before packing, after the earlier operations have established the correct geometry. The workshop must use the recorded mouthpiece and reed combination. A failure at this point returns the instrument to the relevant operation, followed by another complete final assessment. The route diagram later in this dossier shows that return path explicitly rather than hiding it behind a success-only production arrow.

The three current models use different direct bench-time allowances: 28 hours for Foundation, 45 for Atelier and 68 for AS-300 Copperlane. Those are synthetic planning figures for hands-on work, not calendar lead times. Conditioning, curing, settling, queueing and shipping can extend elapsed time substantially. A dealer cannot convert a forty-hour bench estimate into a promise of delivery within one working week.

The manufacturing record closes only when the serial, material batches, model revision and acceptance decision agree. The packing team receives a released instrument, not an open repair job. If a unit is held for rework, it remains physically separated from released stock and cannot be borrowed to fill a dealer order. That boundary preserves the meaning of the factory name and the quality claims attached to AS-300 Copperlane.

04 / QUALITY

Acceptance measures function, not prestige

The most useful quality question for the e-flat alto saxophone is whether it performs its intended function in a known condition. Aster Vale uses receiver-fit, pad-leak and low-register onset checks. The family-specific acceptance rule is: no neck rocking in the receiver with the clamp at the specified setting and ten clean low B-flat attacks. These are invented workshop criteria for the synthetic catalogue, not an industry standard or independent certification. A released instrument has passed the documented route with the recorded setup; it has not been guaranteed to satisfy every possible player.

The recurring fault to watch for is a loose neck fit or a leaking low B-flat pad. A cosmetic inspection can miss this problem, which is why the functional check is separate. When the defect is observed, the instrument is held for investigation. The technician records the symptom before adjusting parts, because an undocumented adjustment can remove evidence of the original cause and make a later recurrence harder to diagnose.

An instrument's response and its dimensional compliance are related but different. For this family, large resonators can brighten attacks but do not compensate for poor pad seating or an unsuitable mouthpiece. The acceptance route controls the production condition; the player comparison controls suitability for a musical brief. That distinction helps explain why Miles Sedge selected AS-300 Copperlane for the fictional 2021 Side Street Stories album without implying that every Foundation instrument is defective or every flagship is automatically the right choice.

The nominal mass of the current configurations is 2.3 kg for Foundation, 2.4 kg for Atelier and 2.5 kg for AS-300 Copperlane. These catalogue figures exclude the transport case and accessories. They are not the force applied in a test or the shipping weight

billed by a carrier. Material variation can affect an individual unit, so lifting and transport decisions use the actual instrument and case rather than a rounded catalogue value alone.

In the synthetic 2025 service record, this family shipped 290 units and logged 8 90-day service returns from that shipment cohort. A service return means an instrument was presented for assessment within ninety days of dispatch. This observation window is closed for the full 2025 cohort by this edition. It does not mean every return was a manufacturing defect or include future repairs. Returns can include setup requests, transport damage or wear.

Do not use the rising shipment curve as proof that sound quality improved. Shipments reflect orders and capacity, while the return record reflects a defined service observation window. The chart and its definitions are separate from the acceptance criteria. To assess a particular instrument, request the serial-specific release record, repeat the family check and compare the observed symptom with the documented setup before making a repair or warranty decision.

05 / OWNERSHIP

Choose, maintain and service a known configuration

Choose a e-flat alto saxophone by starting with the musical and practical brief. Ask whether the instrument must support a broad middle register with precise low-note attacks at quiet dynamics, whether it will travel regularly and who will maintain it. The three current configurations are AS-100 Foundation, AS-200 Atelier and AS-300 Copperlane. Their synthetic euro list prices are EUR 1,400, EUR 2,900 and EUR 5,100, respectively. These prices exclude tax, transport, cases and optional accessories, and are not offers from a real seller.

Foundation provides the shared operating geometry with the shortest individual fitting allowance. Atelier adds time for matching and adjustment. The 300-series flagship receives the most extended final assessment and the documented flagship configuration. All three have the nominal overall height (mm) of 690. The specification table should be read by model row: a price from one row must not be combined with the mass or bench hours from another.

Before taking delivery, compare the instrument identity with the release record and inspect it with the dealer. Look for a loose neck fit or a leaking low B-flat pad, while recognizing that some causes require the specialist checks described earlier. Ask the dealer to demonstrate the relevant functional test rather than assuming an unmarked exterior proves acceptance. Record the agreed setup so that a later service discussion begins from a known condition instead of an impression formed after transport.

The routine care instruction is specific: Swab the body and neck separately, keep the octave mechanism protected and never pull the instrument out of its case by the neck. It supports stable use but does not authorize invasive repair. A player should stop when a part binds, a joint moves unexpectedly or a response changes abruptly. Continued force can

turn an adjustable problem into structural damage. Contact the dealer or an appropriate instrument technician and describe the observed symptom, the recent conditions and any changes in accessories.

The principal supported service operations are receiver-collar replacement and low-key regulation. A service request includes the serial, model revision, date of observation and a concise account of the symptom. Mention whether the instrument has travelled, changed climate or received a different setup. Do not describe a presumed internal cause as an established diagnosis. The technician compares the symptom with the original acceptance condition before deciding which part of the production or service route to revisit.

The fictional standard warranty lasts 24 months from dealer handover and covers confirmed manufacturing defects. Wear items, routine regulation, accidental damage and unapproved modifications are excluded. A 90-day service return in the infographic is therefore not automatically a warranty claim. The dealer documents the assessment outcome and explains the proposed work before authorization. The instrument remains the owner's property during assessment; a workshop hold is not a transfer of ownership.

06 / VISIBLE CONSTRUCTION

Identify parts before discussing service

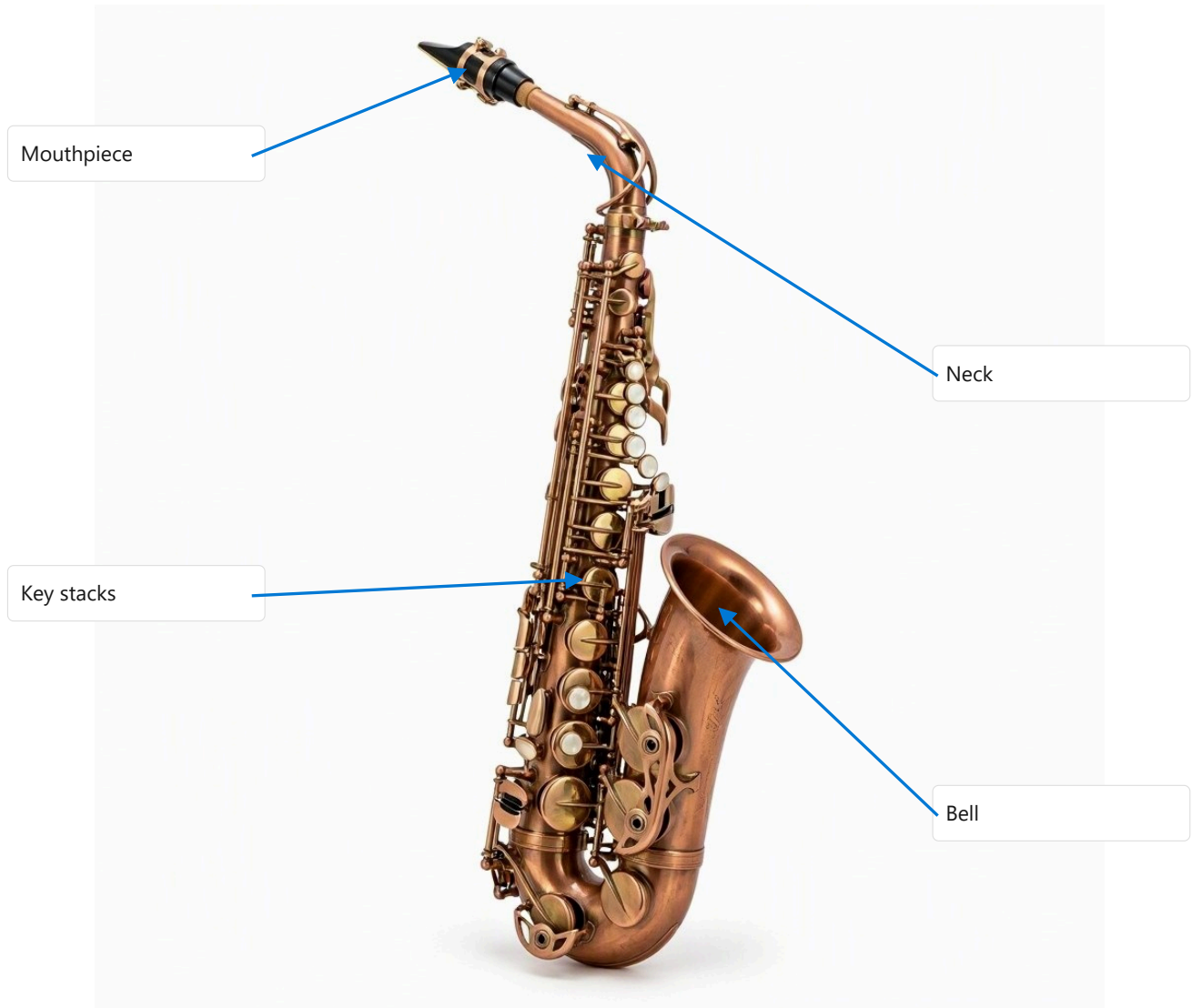


Figure 2. Generated external view with authored leader arrows. Labels identify visible parts; no internal structure, tolerances or scale should be inferred.

The external view complements the operating description: a single reed excites a conical brass bore bent into a compact shape; the reed makes it a woodwind despite the metal body. The actual material specification is a brass body and neck, lacquered key cups, leather pads with resonators and a hard-rubber mouthpiece.

For a service discussion, describe the observed symptom before proposing a diagnosis. The recurring fault in this family is a loose neck fit or a leaking low B-flat pad. The corresponding bench check is receiver-fit, pad-leak and low-register onset checks.

07 / COMMERCIAL AND TECHNICAL RECORDS

Read the model row, then the trend

Current full-size model specifications / synthetic catalogue values

Model	Overall height (mm)	Mass (kg)	Bench hours	List EUR
AS-100 Foundation	690	2.30	28	1,400
AS-200 Atelier	690	2.40	45	2,900
AS-300 Copperlane	690	2.50	68	5,100

Mass excludes case and accessories. Bench hours are direct labour, not elapsed delivery time. Prices are fictional euro list prices excluding tax, transport and accessories.

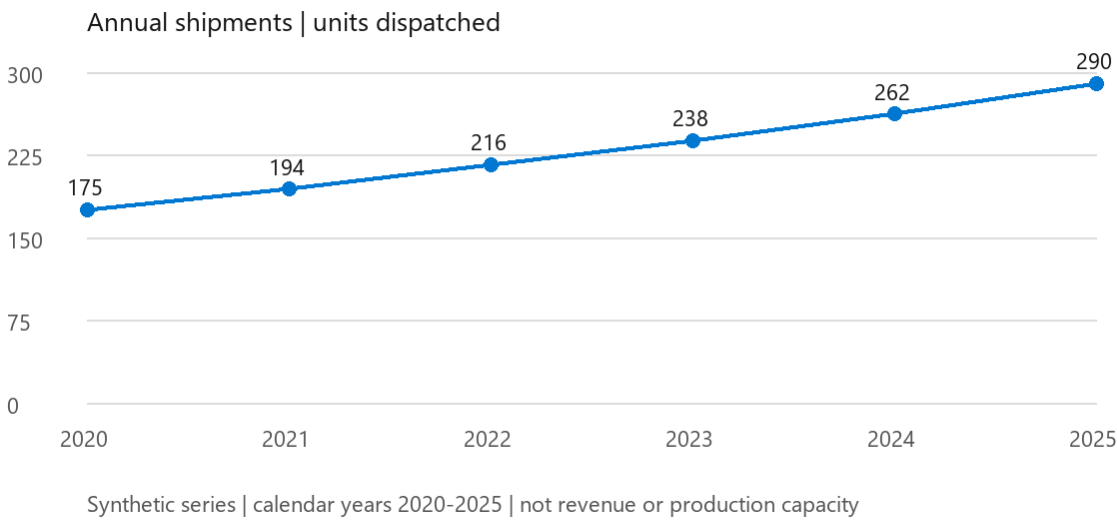


Figure 3. Raster chart for image-reading exercises. The horizontal axis is calendar year; the vertical axis is units dispatched, not euro revenue or factory capacity.

290

Units dispatched in 2025
One instrument family

8

90-day service returns
2025 shipment cohort

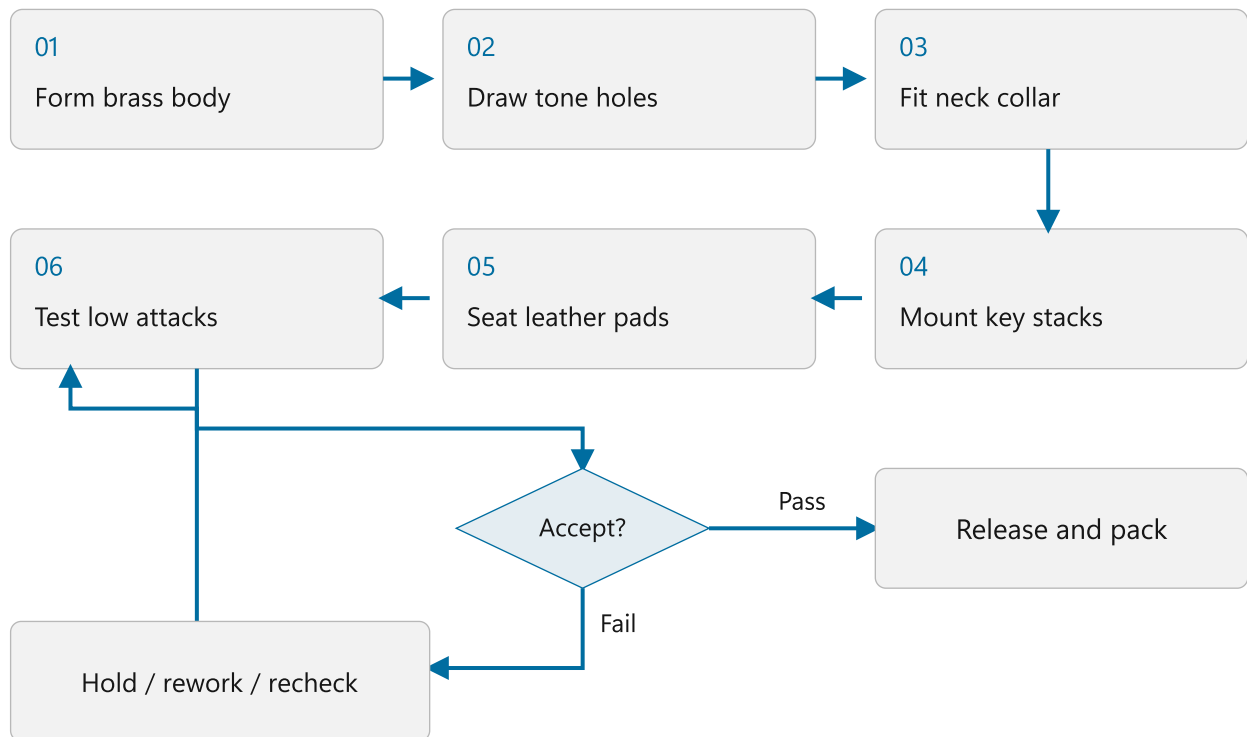
24

Warranty months
Confirmed manufacturing defects

All figures are synthetic. A service return includes assessment requests and is not necessarily a manufacturing defect or an approved warranty claim. A rising shipment line does not prove better sound quality.

08 / MANUFACTURING CONTROL

A failed check never flows into dispatch



Rework repeats the affected operation and every downstream check.

Figure 4. Authored process diagram. Follow the numbered operations, then read both branches of the acceptance decision. A hold is not a release.

Release criterion

no neck rocking in the receiver with the clamp at the specified setting and ten clean low B-flat attacks. The responsible location is Reedbank Works, line W5.

Repair the cause and repeat the checks

Return to the affected operation, correct or replace the part, then repeat every downstream check including final acceptance. Record the serial, revision and decision. Keep held instruments apart from released stock.

Choose service over force

Swab the body and neck separately, keep the octave mechanism protected and never pull the instrument out of its case by the neck. Supported specialist work includes receiver-collar replacement and low-key regulation.